QUICK START

ATEM Logger

Log every switcher cut to an EDL, then rebuild the live edit in DaVinci Resolve.

Version 1.1
github.com/La8Grt8/atem-logger

ATEM Logger runs as a background service on a computer on the same network as your ATEM switcher. It records every program change (from the panel, ATEM Software Control, macros or anything else) with timecode, and saves it as a **CMX 3600 EDL**. Record each camera separately (HyperDecks or camera cards), then conform the EDL in Resolve against those files to get the switched show back. You control it from a web page.

Links Live Media studio setup

Control page	`http://192.168.11.146:9920` from any device on the studio network `http://localhost:9920` on the Mac Mini itself
Runs on	Studio Mac Mini, as a **background service** that starts at boot. Control it from the ◎ **menu-bar icon**
Switcher	ATEM 2 M/E Constellation 4K · `192.168.11.240`
Reels	1 Host → **CAM1** · 2 Wide → **CAM2** · 3 Guest → **CAM3**

1 Install (one time per computer)

Mac

Download the ZIP from GitHub and unzip it somewhere permanent. Double-click **Install on Mac.command** and enter your Mac password. If macOS blocks it, right-click → **Open**.

Windows

Download the ZIP and unzip it somewhere permanent. Double-click **Install on Windows.bat** and click **Yes** for administrator rights. If SmartScreen appears, click **More info → Run anyway**.

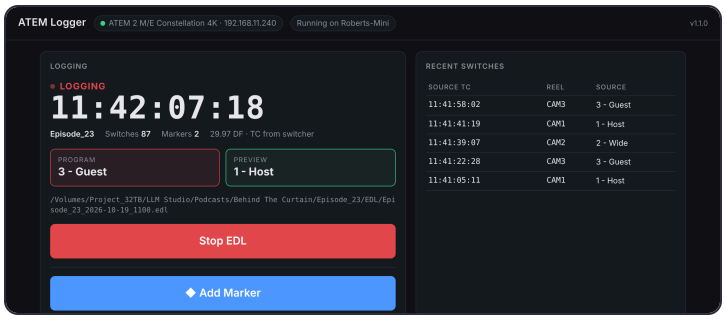
Docker / ZimaBoard

Use image `ghcr.io/la8grt8/atem-logger` with `docker-compose.yml` from the repo. Map `/edl` to where EDLs should land.

The installers set up Node.js if it's missing, install the background service, the menu-bar/tray icon and the `atem-logger` command, then open the control page. Don't move the folder afterwards, because the service runs from it.

2 First-time setup

1. **Switcher:** open *Switcher & timecode settings* (bottom right), enter the ATEM's IP, and click **Save settings**. The pill at the top turns green with the switcher model when connected.
2. **Reel names:** give each camera input a short reel (max 8 characters), e.g. `CAM1`, then click **Save reel names**. Blank uses the ATEM's short name. **No two cameras may share a reel.**
3. **Timecode:** leave *Switcher timecode* selected if the cameras, HyperDecks and ATEM share the same time-of-day timecode (e.g. Tentacle Sync). Check that the status line's **DF / NDF** matches your camera timecode.



The control page during a show: live timecode, program/preview, recent switches, and the Stop and Add Marker buttons.

3 Running a show

Before you roll

- [ ] Header pill is green and shows the switcher.
- [ ] Program / Preview match what's on the multiview.
- [ ] Type the **title** (e.g. `Episode_23`) and the **save folder** for this episode.
- [ ] Project drive is mounted.
- [ ] Cameras / HyperDecks are recording with synced timecode.

Roll

Click **Start EDL**. The page shows ● LOGGING, running timecode and the switch count. Cut the show as normal from any panel or software.

Markers

Mark a moment for the edit: a great soundbite, a retake, a clip for social.

- Click **◆ Add Marker**, or
- press `M` anywhere on the page, or
- type a note in the box under the button and press **Enter**.

Wrap

Click **Stop EDL** and confirm. Your files are in the save folder:

- `Episode_23_<date>_<time>.edl`, the cuts
- `…_markers.edl`, only if you added markers

They're also listed under **EDL files** for download.

> **The EDL is saved after every cut.** If the computer or app restarts mid-show, nothing already logged is lost. The page points you to the partial file, and you can start a new EDL to keep going.

4 Conform in DaVinci Resolve

1. **Project Settings → Master Settings:** set the timeline frame rate to the show's rate (e.g. 29.97) *before* adding media.
2. **Project Settings → General Options → Conform Options:** tick **Assist using reel names from the: Source clip filename**. You need this in every new project, so add it to your project template.
3. **Rename each camera file to its reel** (`CAM1.mov`, `CAM2.mov`, `CAM3.mov`) and import them into the Media Pool.
4. **File → Import → Timeline**, pick the `.edl`, and **untick** *Automatically import source clips into media pool*.
5. **Markers:** right-click the new timeline in the Media Pool → **Timelines → Import → Timeline Markers from EDL**, and pick the `_markers.edl`.
6. **Check sync** at a clap or hard consonant. Lay the separately recorded audio underneath and line it up.

5 Updates

The app checks GitHub for a new version when it starts and every few hours. When there is one, the control page shows a banner (**Update now · What's new · Later**) and the icon asks once. Updating takes about a minute and restarts the service. It's **blocked while an EDL is being logged**, so it can never interrupt a show. To check yourself, go to *Switcher & timecode settings → Check for updates*. On Docker, run `docker compose pull && docker compose up -d` instead.

6 Service controls

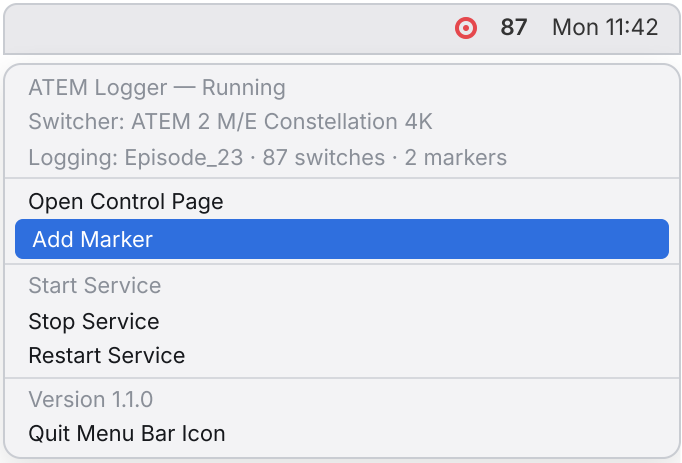
ATEM Logger runs as a **background service**. It starts when the computer boots, even if nobody logs in, and restarts itself within seconds if it ever crashes. You can stop it any time from the icon or the command line. It stays stopped until you start it again or the computer reboots.

Menu-bar / tray icon

On a Mac it's next to the clock. On Windows it's in the system tray (you may need the ^ arrow). The colour shows the state:

- **Grey**: service stopped
- **Orange**: running, switcher not connected
- **Green**: running and connected, ready
- **Red**: logging (Mac also shows the switch count)

Click it to open the control page, add a marker, start/stop/restart the service, or install an update. Stopping or restarting while logging asks first and finalizes the EDL. **Quit** only removes the icon, and the service keeps running.



The Mac menu during a show (illustration). The Windows menu is the same.

Command line

Use Terminal on a Mac, or any new terminal window on Windows.

`atem-logger status`	Running or stopped, switcher connection, logging state and EDL file
`atem-logger stop`	Stop the service. Any EDL in progress is finalized first
`atem-logger start` · `restart`	Start or restart it. No password needed for admins
`atem-logger open` · `logs`	Open the control page · follow the log
`atem-logger disable` · `enable`	Don't start / do start at boot (asks for an admin password)

7 Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Red pill: "Not connected"	Check the switcher is on and the IP is right. The computer must reach the ATEM on **UDP 9910**, which is the same as ATEM Software Control. The app reconnects on its own.
"Switcher connection lost" during a show	Logging keeps running and resumes when the switcher reconnects. Cuts made while disconnected aren't captured, so note the time.
"Could not write the EDL file"	The save folder isn't reachable, usually because the drive is unmounted. Remount it. The next cut rewrites the whole file.
Everything conforms to one camera	The Conform Option in step 4.2 isn't ticked. Tick it and import the EDL again.
Cuts land on the wrong camera	Reel names don't match the file names, or two inputs share a reel. Fix them under **Reel names**, which applies from the next EDL.
Media offline / shots a frame or two off	The camera timecode doesn't match the EDL. Check the cameras and switcher share time-of-day timecode, and that DF/NDF matches. For a constant offset, adjust the clip's Start TC in Resolve.
Page won't open / icon is grey	The service is stopped. Click the icon → **Start Service**, or run `atem-logger start`. After a reboot with FileVault on, someone has to unlock the Mac first. Logs: `~/.atem-logger/logger.log` (Mac), `%USERPROFILE%\.atem-logger\atem-logger-service.out.log` (Windows).
Can't save to a network drive (Windows)	The service can't see mapped drive letters. Use the full share path, e.g. `\\nas\projects\EDL`.
Update failed	The banner shows why, and the old version keeps running. Click **Try again**, or re-run the installer.